

DIGITAL ACCESSIBILITY STANDARD

See Also:

RCW [43.105.054](#) WaTech Governance

RCW [43.105.052](#) Powers and duties of agency—Application to higher education, legislature, and judiciary.

RCW [43.105.020](#) (22) "State agency"

1. The minimum level of accessibility compliance for [covered technology](#) is Level AA compliance with [Web Content Accessibility Guidelines \(WCAG\) 2.1](#), including the guidelines associated with these principles:
 - a. [Perceivable](#) - Information and user interface components must be presentable to users in ways they can comprehend.
 - b. [Operable](#) - User interface components and navigation must be operable.
 - c. [Understandable](#) - Information and the operation of user interface must be understandable.
 - d. [Robust](#) - Content must be robust enough that it can be interpreted reliably by a wide variety of user agents, including assistive technologies.
2. [WCAG 2.1](#) AA provides success criteria for measuring web accessibility and provides principles and useful metrics for products and services that are not specifically web based.
3. Effective July 1, 2026, the minimum level of compliance for accessibility is Level AA compliance with [WCAG 2.2](#).
4. Agency covered technology procurement and contracting activities must include the following:
 - a. Accessibility requirements in the procurement, design, project scope, budget, and maintenance of IT Project/Systems applications and IT services.
 - b. Accessibility validation:
 - i. Ensure agency or third-party human user testing to validate accessibility, and;
 - ii. A third-party accessibility validation report, or;

- iii. Vendor Product Accessibility Template (VPAT) or;
 - iv. Compliance review documentation showing an evaluation of the solution's compliance with the applicable WCAG level.
- c. Remediation activities:
- i. Require a remediation plan from the vendor for addressing accessibility issues.
 - ii. Evaluate the vendor's remediation plan and timeline and determine contractual clauses to enforce remediation.
 - iii. Where the vendor does not have a remediation plan, and no other accessible solution will meet the agency's needs, agencies must:
 - 1. Ensure alternative methods for access are incorporated into the agency's IT Accessibility Plan. Alternative access methods must also comply with applicable Washington State IT policies and standards.
 - 2. Reserve the right to reduce the amount or terminate contracts where vendors demonstrate a lack of accountability to timely response and remediation and accessibility improvements with new releases and updates. This also applies if a vendor misrepresents the current accessibility of their products.
 - 3. Consider the track record of vendors through comprehensive evaluation of accessibility and prioritization of accessibility, including contract violations, in renewal processes or new procurement processes.

REFERENCES

1. [Web Content Accessibility Guidelines \(WCAG\) 2.1.](#)
2. [Web Content Accessibility Guidelines \(WCAG\) 2.2.](#)
3. [Definition of Terms Used in WaTech Policies and Reports.](#)
4. [Guidance on Applying WCAG 2 to Non-Web Information and Communications Technologies \(WCAG2ICT\)](#)

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the [WaTech Policy Mailbox](#).

DEFINITIONS

Covered Technology:

All public-facing digital content and tools, including:

- Websites,
- applications,
- documents and media,
- blog posts, and
- social media content.

Certain non-public-facing content that must also comply including:

- All electronic content used for official business to communicate,
- emergency notifications,
- internal data collection structures,
- initial or final decisions adjudicating administrative claims or proceedings,
- internal or external program or policy announcements,
- notices of benefits, program eligibility, employment opportunities, or
- personnel actions, formal acknowledgements or receipts.